

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Disney is making** a \$1 billion investment in OpenAI and will allow the platform to use its characters and properties to generate short, user-prompted social videos. **A1**

◆ **OpenAI is being sued** for wrongful death by the estate of a woman killed by her son, who had been engaging in delusion-filled conversations with ChatGPT. **B1**

◆ **Treasury yields** slipped for a second straight session after the Fed's rate cut Wednesday and the S&P 500 and Dow hit records, rising 0.2% and 1.3%, respectively. The Nasdaq fell 0.3%. **B1**

◆ **Oracle helped to drag** the tech-laden index into the red, falling 11% in a stark display of investors' concerns about tech companies' overspending on artificial-intelligence infrastructure. **B1**

◆ **A rebalanced gold trade** was largely responsible for narrowing the U.S. trade deficit to its lowest level in five years in September. **A2**

◆ **Broadcom reported** rapid quarterly revenue growth as demand continued to rise for chips to equip the data centers that power AI models. **B1**

◆ **Calvin McDonald** will step down as chief executive of Lululemon, which has been under pressure from its founder to reverse a "loss of cool." **B1**

◆ **Do Kwon was sentenced** to 15 years in prison after pleading guilty to fraud in connection with the \$40 billion crash of his TerraUSD and Luna coins in 2022. **B1**

World-Wide

◆ **A Democratic effort** to extend expiring healthcare subsidies drew some Republican votes but failed to advance in the Senate, and a GOP approach also failed, leaving no clear path in Congress for alleviating the higher ACA costs Americans face in 2026. **A1**

◆ **Venezuela's Nobel Peace** Prize laureate praised the U.S. seizure of an oil tanker off her country's coast, saying it was necessary to choke the finances of the Maduro regime. **A1, A8**

◆ **The Indiana Senate** rejected a congressional redistricting plan in a rebuke to Trump, who mounted a pressure campaign on Republican lawmakers. **A3**

◆ **A grand jury refused** to indict New York Attorney General Letitia James for a second time, deflating the Justice Department's effort to prosecute the Trump critic. **A4**

◆ **Kilmar Abrego Garcia** was released from immigration custody after a judge ruled that the government couldn't continue to hold the Salvadoran indefinitely. **A3**

◆ **Trump said he was granting** a pardon to a former Colorado election official serving time on state charges in a case that is typically beyond the president's reach. **A4**

◆ **Ukraine and its European** allies sent Trump a response to his team's peace plan, Germany's chancellor said. **A9**

◆ **Bulgaria's government** collapsed after a wave of youth-driven street protests. **A9**

JOURNAL REPORT
C-Suite Strategies: Nvidia tops the list of best-managed companies of 2025. **R1-B**

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Floods Bring Evacuation Order in Pacific Northwest



EMERGENCY: Days of torrential rain in Washington's Cascade Mountains caused flooding in towns including Arlington, seen on Thursday, as well as mudslides and road and Amtrak closures. Tens of thousands of people were told to evacuate. **A6**

Seizure of Venezuelan Oil Puts Maduro's Grip on Power at Risk

U.S. officials say they plan to confiscate more tankers in bid to oust strongman

The Trump administration's seizure of a tanker full of Venezuelan crude hits Nicolás Maduro much harder than air-

By Ryan Dubé,
Shelby Holliday
and Benoit Faucon

strikes on alleged drug boats. It raises an existential crisis for a regime that runs on oil revenue.

While the U.S. has accused Maduro of leading a drug-traf-

ficking cartel—a charge he denies—oil money is far more important to the Venezuelan leader, his inner circle and the country itself. Crude sales have long represented more than 90% of Venezuela's export income, and close Maduro allies have faced accusations of skimming from billions in annual oil revenues.

More tanker seizures—or even just the threat—creates an escalating series of crises, forcing Venezuela to deeply discount its oil to its handful of buyers, including China, and spend more of its dwindling foreign reserves to stop spiraling inflation.

Underscoring the danger:

the tanker seized on Wednesday was carrying roughly \$80 million of oil, equivalent to about 5% of what Venezuela spends monthly on imported goods, raising the prospect of shortages.

U.S. officials on Wednesday said there would be more ship seizures in a new effort to force Maduro from power, an effort that has involved a massive military buildup in the Caribbean, deadly strikes on alleged drug boats, and threats of bombing Venezuela. President Trump has said Maduro's "days are numbered," though he hasn't publicly committed to a next course of action.

The U.S. move against the oil

industry "could destabilize the regime," said Fernando Ferreira, a geopolitical director at consulting firm Rapidan Energy Group in Washington. Trump, he added, "is building more leverage to get Maduro to leave."

If the U.S. seizes just one tanker a month, that would push Venezuela into a recession, said Francisco Rodríguez, a Venezuelan economist at the University of Denver. "If you cause a massive decline in oil revenues, that's going to cause another massive recession," he said.

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◆ **Machado, in Norway, hails U.S. help.....** **A8**

Cheap Power Gives Beijing AI Edge

Grid is world's biggest; tech leaders worry about U.S.-China 'electron gap'

By Raffaele Huang
and Brian Spegele

ULANQAB, China—The U.S. invented the most powerful artificial-intelligence models and controls access to the most advanced computer chips, but China has an ace to play in the global AI contest.

China now has the biggest power grid the world has ever seen. Between 2010 and 2024, its power production increased by more than the rest of the world combined.

Last year, China generated more than twice as much electricity as the U.S. Some Chinese data centers are now paying less than half what American ones pay for electricity.

"In China, electricity is our competitive advantage," Liu Liehong, head of China's National Data Administration, said in March.

The push for power supremacy is transforming remote expanses of Inner Mongolia, a Texas-like land-

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In Bots vs. Hackers, AI Is Close to Winning

By Robert McMillan

After years of misfires, artificial-intelligence hacking tools have become dangerously good.

So good that they are even surpassing some human hackers, according to a novel experiment conducted recently at Stanford University.

A Stanford team spent a good chunk of the past year tinkering with an AI bot called Artemis. It takes a similar approach to Chinese hackers who had been using Anthropic's generative AI software to break into major corporations and foreign governments.

Artemis scans the network, finds potential bugs—software vulnerabilities—and then finds ways to exploit them.

Then the Stanford research-

ers let Artemis out of the lab, using it to find bugs in a real-world computer network—the one used by Stanford's own engineering department. And to make things interesting, they pitted Artemis against real-world professional hackers, known as penetration testers.

Their experiment is outlined in a paper that was published on Wednesday.

"This was the year that models got good enough," said Rob Ragan, a researcher with the cybersecurity firm Bishop Fox. His company used large language models, or LLMs, to build a set of tools that can find bugs at a much faster and cheaper rate than humans during penetration tests, letting them test far more software than ever before, he said.

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INSIDE



SPORTS
Are the Oklahoma City Thunder the greatest team in NBA history? **A16**

MANSION
More wealthy buyers prefer homes with everything inside—silverware included. **M1**

Disney Set to Invest \$1 Billion in OpenAI

By Ben Fritz
and Joseph De Avila

Disney is making a \$1 billion investment in OpenAI and will allow the AI platform to use its characters and properties to generate short, user-prompted social videos.

Disney's three-year licensing deal will let users generate videos using Sora, OpenAI's short-form AI video platform, of more than 200 Disney, Marvel, Star Wars and Pixar characters. A curated selection of these short videos will be available to stream on Disney+.

Until a few years ago, generative AI was hardly a concern for Hollywood compared with falling box-office receipts

Senate Efforts To Extend Healthcare Fall Short

Democrats, GOP fail to advance proposals, leaving ACA clients in precarious position

WASHINGTON—A Democratic effort to extend expiring healthcare subsidies drew some Republican votes but failed Thursday to advance in the Senate, and a GOP approach also failed, leaving no clear path in Congress for aiding millions of Americans facing soaring Affordable Care Act insurance costs next year.

By Lindsay Wise,
Siobhan Hughes and
Anna Wilde Mathews

The Democratic proposal would have extended the enhanced Covid-era ACA subsidies for three years. The bill was backed by 51 senators—including Republican Sens. Lisa Murkowski and Dan Sullivan of Alaska, Susan Collins of Maine and Josh Hawley of Missouri—with 48 opposed, short of the 60 votes needed to advance under the Senate's filibuster rule.

Republicans, who control the chamber 53-47, put forward an alternative healthcare bill that wouldn't extend the subsidies but instead offers federal funds to some households to put toward out-of-pocket healthcare costs. The Republican proposal also failed with 51 in favor and 48 opposed. GOP Sen. Rand Paul of Kentucky sided with Democrats in voting against the measure. Sen. Steve Daines (R, Mont.) was absent for both votes.

The lack of progress in Congress has left many of the nation's ACA enrollees in a precarious situation. With open enrollment generally closing

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They Fall Asleep to the Sound Of a Man Talking About Murders

Fans find comfort in the soothing voice of 'Forensic Files' host; 'I'm out like a light'

By Rebecca Reisner

Dennis Long discovered "Forensic Files" when Court TV showed a marathon of the docuseries in the early 2000s.

"I would stay up the whole time even if it meant a few cups of coffee," says Long, who lives in Shamokin, Pa. "It just was and still is the gold standard that every other true crime show aspires to be."

The 43-year-old still appreciates the series—and for more than the thrill of learning how investigators identified a mummified pregnant woman hidden in a barrel on Long Island.

Long turns on "Forensic

Files" when he has trouble getting to sleep. "Less than 30 minutes later, and I'm out like a light," he says.

He is part of a subset of true crime fans who listen to the series—produced from 1996 to 2011 and still a syndication juggernaut seen in more than 100 countries—because they find narrator Peter Thomas's voice both engaging and anesthetizing.

"He talks about very intense things, but doesn't do it in a way that provokes anxiety," says Sarah Bodem, who lives in Boynton Beach, Fla., and has watched all 400 or so episodes at least twice. The

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TOMORROW



WSJ.
MAGAZINE

MOZAMBIQUE